

Development of Hope in Faith

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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They are from the YouTube channel Repentance 101. The Millers. G'day and welcome to this podcast. I'm your host Ashton. Today we're going to continue with a series called Building Faith. The question today is how is our hope when we are hoping for things to come and what the quality of our faith looks like as we are hoping for those things to materialize. Our text comes from Romans 4 verses 18 to 22. Abraham, who contrary to hope, in hope believed, so that he became the father of many nations according to what was spoken.

And not being weak in faith, he did not consider his own body already dead since he was about a hundred years old and the deadness of Sarah's womb. He did not waver at the promise of God through unbelief, but was strengthened in faith, giving glory to God and being fully convinced that what he had promised, he was also able to perform. And therefore it was accounted to him righteousness. The word hope translates as an expectation to expect something to happen.

The other version of it is to flee towards something. It's like when a child has been bullied and the bully is chasing a child. When the child is running for the door of their house, they're running with the hope and expectation that when they get to the door, the bully will cease and desist. They will get help from their parents. This is the type of hope that Abram had when he was hoping in God. It was a flee towards what the father had promised him.

Instead of looking at the deadness in his wife's womb and looking at how old he was, he decided rather to trust in the promises of God and stay in the hope that what God said he was

going to do will be fulfilled regardless of what the circumstances look like. But under pressure, Abraham stayed faithful. Abram chose not to look at what was natural. Abram chose not to look at his age. He chose not to look at his wife's age. But he chose rather to see in the realm of the spirit what God had promised him.

Kings, nations, a son. Let's break down the text a little bit. It says in verse 18, who contrary to hope, in hope, believed, so that he became father of many nations. Abraham, that word contrary to hope, in hope, believed, meant that he wasn't only just believing God, but he was holding steadfastly to what God had said. Regardless of the situation, as I've said it twice before, he held on firmly to the promises of what God had said. Verse 19 says, not being weak in faith.

As we've been through this podcast, we know that there are various types of faith. There's little faith, great faith, and there's weakness in faith. That means he was not persuaded by the things that were happening around him. So even though everybody around him was having children at younger ages, he was not persuaded by it. He never allowed his faith to look at them as a marker for his own life, but in the Spirit saw what God had promised for him, a son, and with that he had faith and hope towards that promise.

Verse 20 says, he staggered, wavered, or hesitated not at the promises of God. God's promises do not fail. People fail God's promises. Every promise that is given in the Bible comes with a condition. Every single promise given in the Bible comes with a condition. If you believe, if you are obedient, if you hear, if you do, then these things will come upon you. The only promises that do not come with a condition are the pre-man blessings. That is the light that God created.

The Word of God says that the rain falleth on those who are evil and those who are good. The light also shines on the evil and also the good. The pre-man blessings everybody receives without condition. But the blessings of God that he promises to us come with a condition. And Abraham stood in faith for the promises of God. He did not waver. He did not allow a day to come in and creep in and says, well, you know, maybe it's just kind of not for me because this, that, and the other.

As most people like to do when they rely on their carnal senses for the spiritual things of God. And verse 20 says, he was strong in faith. That means he woke up believing. That means he woke up receiving it in the realm of the spirit. That means when everybody else was playing with their children, he knew one day he's going to play with his child. And that's the kind of strength and the kind of faith that moved God when God was with Abraham to give Abraham the blessings that he had promised.

Verse 21 says, There was not an inkling, you know, in the church we say, God is more than able and so on and so forth. And it's just, yes, yes, sir, no, sir. Amen to that. God is more than able and so on and so forth. Good all the time, but how many people are fully persuaded that the blessing that God is about to release is actually going to come on their life? You see, God cannot be fooled. God cannot be mocked. God cannot be deceived. He knows your faith.

He sees your faith. Your faith attracts God to Him. Your faith stands out. Jesus said, what great faith, standing out kind of faith. And He also said, what little faith. So you and I have to be fully persuaded, unwavering, that through my obedience to God and my faithfulness, that He will be saved.